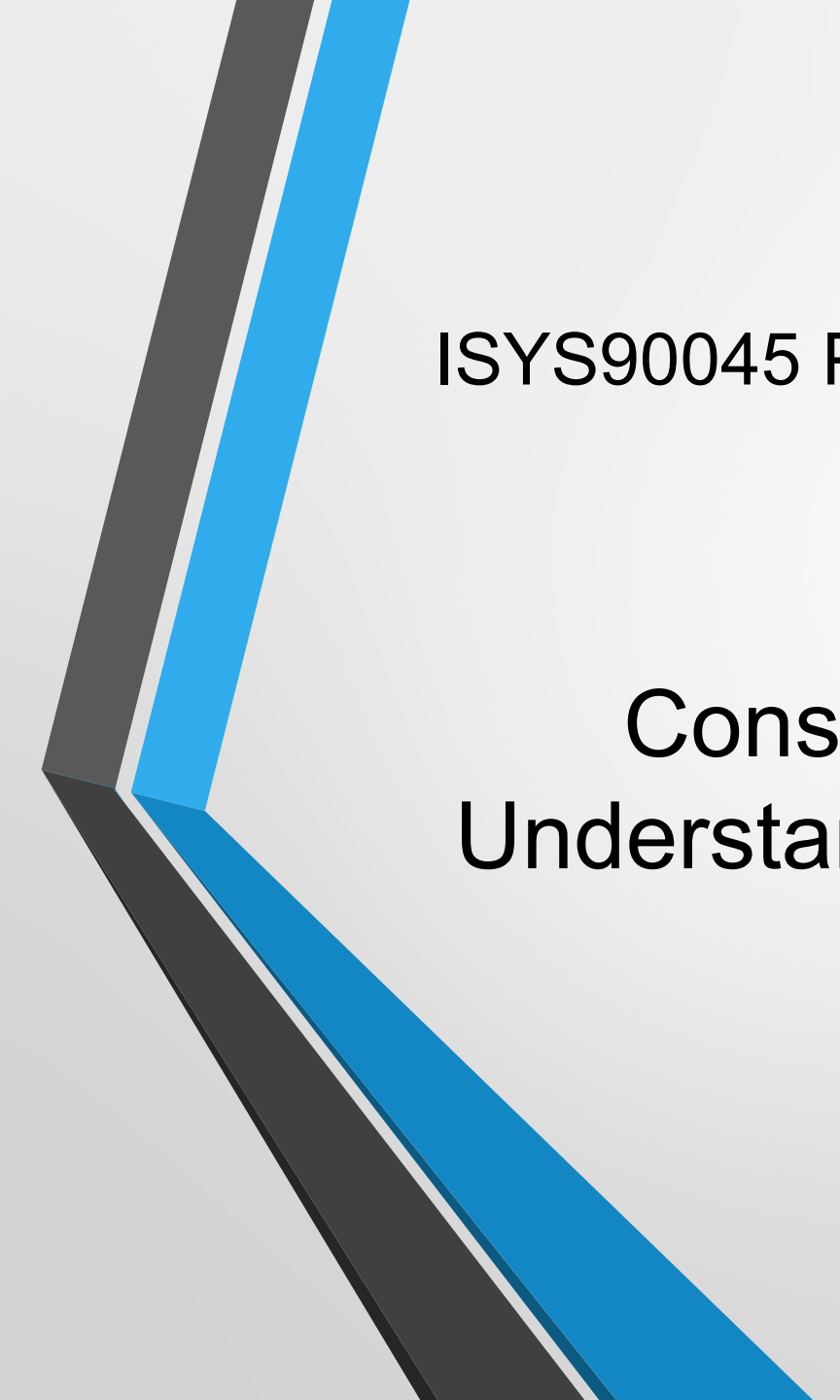
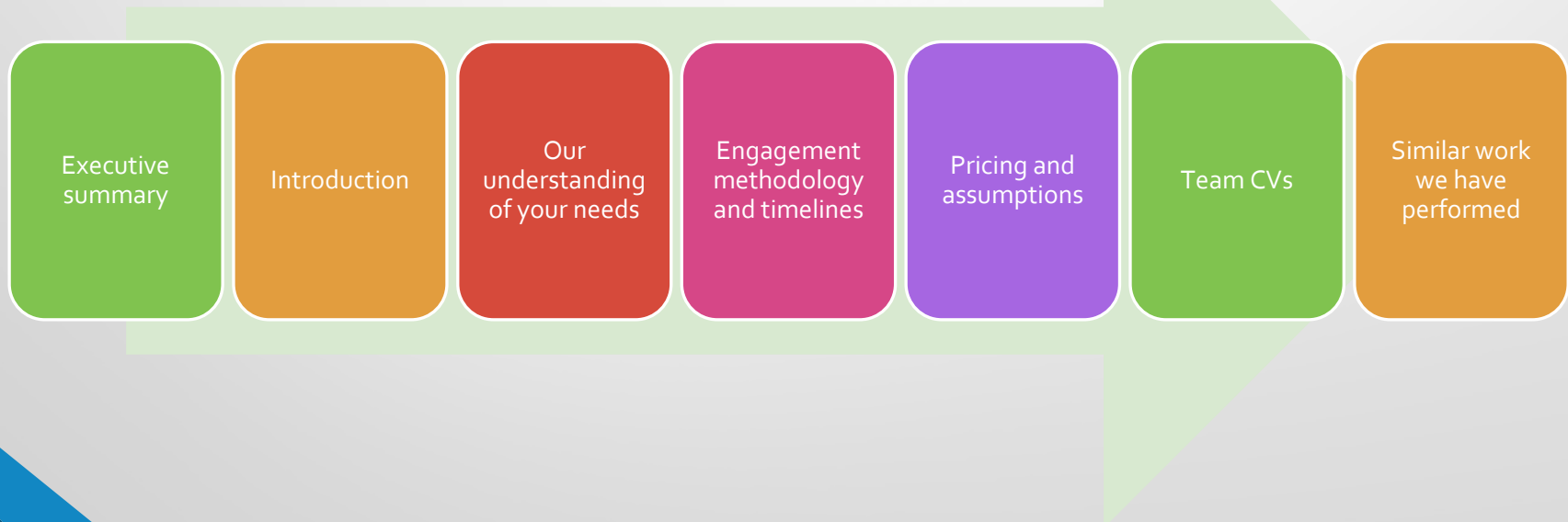




ISYS90045 Professional IS Consulting

Seminar 3
Consulting Proposals
Understanding your audience

Dr Rod Dilnutt



Know your audience

Like a presentation, know your audience for a proposal

We write these for clients. Consider:

Who are they?

May impact language, content, style, information presented, industry experience.

What do they want?

What is the client asking for?
What is the best way we can solve this problem for them?

What don't they want?

Do we sell them something they don't want or need?

Client Ecosystem

It's easy to think about clients in isolation

- ▶ Most consultants will probably consider their industry
- ▶ But, when we're the trusted advisor, we know more about the client...



Our client's customer's customers

Who, external to the organisation, are the end users, impacted parties or consumers of their services? What other parties are there?

Our client's customers

- Who does our client report into? Who are they servicing within their own organisation?
- What's their purpose within the context of the organisation?
- What's their strategy? Where do they want to be heading?
- Where are they within the organisational structure?
- What control and authority do they have?
- Are there bigger issues that we need to also consider?
- What organisational programs are in train or being considered to solve these problems?

Our client

This is our client: the individual or team requesting our assistance and services.

Our client Ecosystem Exercise

Your best friend is a waiter at a small café.

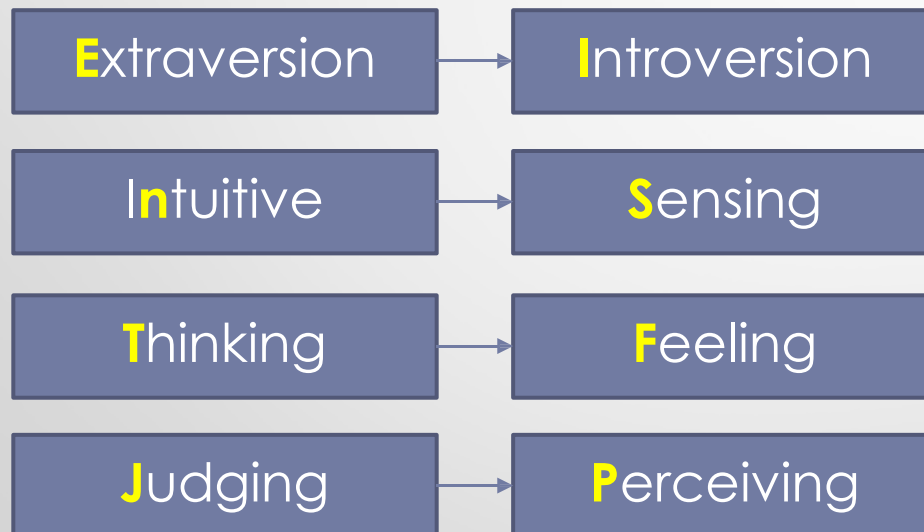
The café is looking for a new point of sales system as theirs is now 25 years old and showing its age.

Your friend knows that you're an IT consultant and has asked for your help – he has been advocating you to her boss. The boss, the café manager, has asked for a proof of concept (PoC) but has largely delegated oversight to your friend.

Let's draw out the ecosystem...

Dealing with different personalities

- ▶ This actually happens!
- ▶ Who are you working with?
- ▶ How will you work with them?
- ▶ Consider the [Myers-Briggs types](#):



Energy from action and externalisation vs. internal ideas and reflection

Gut-feel vs. using your senses

Logic vs. empathy in decision-making

Living your 'outer' life: structured or flexible?

Dealing with different personalities

Personality types:

What's Your Personality Type?

Use the questions on the outside of the chart to determine the four letters of your Myers-Briggs type.
For each pair of letters, choose the side that seems most natural to you, even if you don't agree with every description.

1. Are you outwardly or inwardly focused? If you:

- Could be described as talkative, outgoing
- Like to be in a fast-paced environment
- Tend to work out ideas with others, think out loud
- Enjoy being the center of attention

then you prefer
E
Extraversion

- Could be described as reserved, private
- Prefer a slower pace with time for contemplation
- Tend to think things through inside your head
- Would rather observe than be the center of attention

then you prefer
I
Introversion

ISTJ

Responsible, sincere, analytical, reserved, realistic, systematic. Hardworking and trustworthy with sound practical judgment.

ISFJ

Warm, considerate, gentle, responsible, pragmatic, thorough. Devoted caretakers who enjoy being helpful to others.

INFJ

Idealistic, organized, insightful, dependable, compassionate, gentle. Driven by their own original ideas to achieve improvements.

INTJ

Innovative, independent, strategic, logical, reserved, insightful. Driven by their own original ideas to achieve improvements.

ISTP

Action-oriented, logical, analytical, spontaneous, reserved, independent. Enjoy adventure, skilled at understanding how mechanical things work.

ISFP

Gentle, sensitive, nurturing, helpful, flexible, realistic. Seek to create a personal environment that is both beautiful and practical.

INFP

Sensitive, creative, idealistic, perceptive, caring, loyal. Value inner harmony and personal growth, focus on dreams and possibilities.

INTP

Intellectual, logical, precise, reserved, flexible, imaginative. Original thinkers who enjoy speculation and creative problem solving.

3. How do you prefer to make decisions? If you:

- Make decisions in an impersonal way, using logical reasoning
- Value justice, fairness
- Enjoy finding the flaws in an argument
- Could be described as reasonable, level-headed

then you prefer
T
Thinking

- Base your decisions on personal values and how your actions affect others
- Value harmony, forgiveness
- Like to please others and point out the best in people
- Could be described as warm, empathetic

then you prefer
F
Feeling

2. How do you prefer to take in information? If you:

- Focus on the reality of how things are
- Pay attention to concrete facts and details
- Prefer ideas that have practical applications
- Like to describe things in a specific, literal way

then you prefer
S
Sensing

- Imagine the possibilities of how things could be
- Notice the big picture, see how everything connects
- Enjoy ideas and concepts for their own sake
- Like to describe things in a figurative, poetic way

then you prefer
N
Intuition

ESTP

Outgoing, realistic, action-oriented, curious, versatile, spontaneous. Pragmatic problem solvers and skillful negotiators.

ESFP

Playful, enthusiastic, friendly, spontaneous, tactful, flexible. Have strong common sense, enjoy helping people in tangible ways.

ENFP

Enthusiastic, creative, spontaneous, optimistic, supportive, playful. Value inspiration, enjoy starting new projects, see potential in others.

ENTP

Inventive, enthusiastic, strategic, enterprising, inquisitive, versatile. Enjoy new ideas and challenges, value inspiration.

ESTJ

Efficient, outgoing, analytical, systematic, dependable, realistic. Like to run the show and get things done in an orderly fashion.

ESFJ

Friendly, outgoing, reliable, conscientious, organized, practical. Seek to be helpful and please others, enjoy being active and productive.

ENFJ

Caring, enthusiastic, idealistic, organized, diplomatic, responsible. Skilled communicators who value connection with people.

ENTJ

Strategic, logical, efficient, outgoing, ambitious, independent. Effective organizers of people and long-range planners.

4. How do you prefer to live your outer life? If you:

- Prefer to have matters settled
- Think rules and deadlines should be respected
- Prefer to have detailed, step-by-step instructions
- Make plans, want to know what you're getting into

then you prefer
J
Judging

- Prefer to leave your options open
- See rules and deadlines as flexible
- Like to improvise and make things up as you go
- Are spontaneous, enjoy surprises and new situations

then you prefer
P
Perceiving

Discussion Exercise

Let's see who we are!

Consider the below questions:

At a party, do you interact with many (including strangers), or with a few (known to you)?

Are you more likely to trust your experience, or go by your values and beliefs?

How do you cook dinner – by the recipe, or with freedom?

In these lectures, do you focus on the facts we present, or think about the big picture and what could be?

When you approach someone, are you more objective about them, or personal?

You're on the way to that party from the first question – how do you plan to get there? Do you even plan?

Do you tend to choose something rather carefully, or more impulsively?

What are your preferences?

Dealing with different personalities

- ▶ For discussion here:

Why is it helpful to consider the personality types of clients, your manager, your co-workers in developing a team for a consulting project?

Dealing with different personalities

- ▶ Consultants require communication skills
- ▶ Does this mean they should be extroverts?
- ▶ The 'archetypical' successful business person is often portrayed as an extrovert (in the media)
- ▶ What type of behaviour is involved in higher education?

Summary

Dealing with different personalities

- Decisions are made by people and are based on personal preferences
- A wise consultant will pitch to the client personality
- Pre-work to understand the actors is beneficial